

Regional Growth Analysis

Superstore Sales: Period-over-Period Comparison, 2023-2025

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Task	Task 30 - Day 30 of 45	Tools	SQL, Excel

1. Objective and Approach

This report compares how sales grew across the four regions (West, East, Central, South) over three years, to practice period-over-period comparisons. The dataset contains **5,000 orders** from 01 Jan 2023 to 31 Dec 2025 with sales, profit, discount and product details. Growth was measured three ways: year-over-year (YoY), quarter-over-quarter (QoQ) and compound annual growth rate (CAGR). Calendar years and calendar quarters were used consistently for every region, and the 2024 base was checked for small-base effects.

Note: the dataset is a synthetic Superstore-style dataset created for this exercise, so figures illustrate the method and are not real company results.

2. Summary

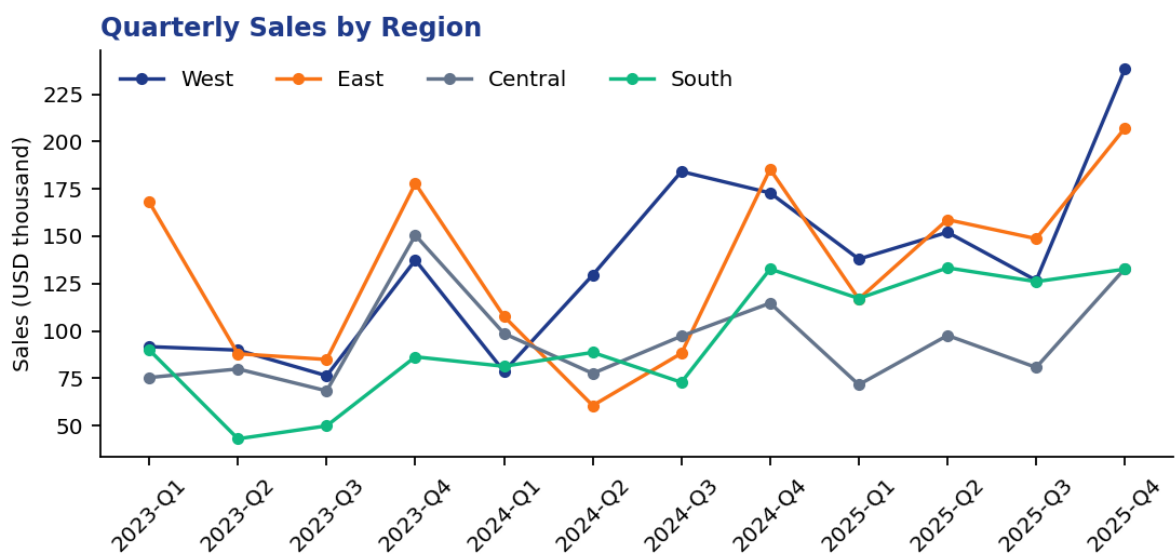
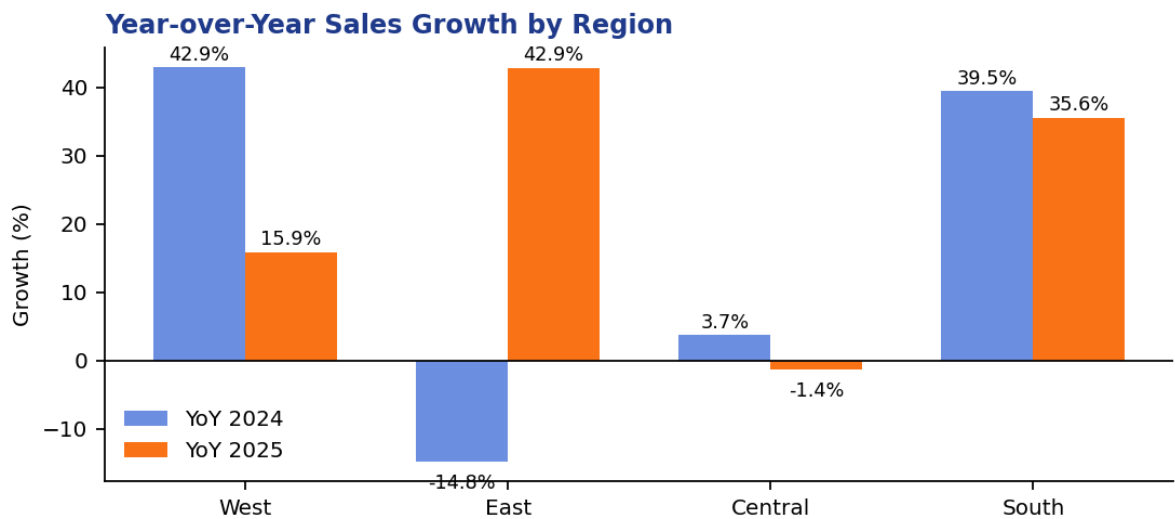
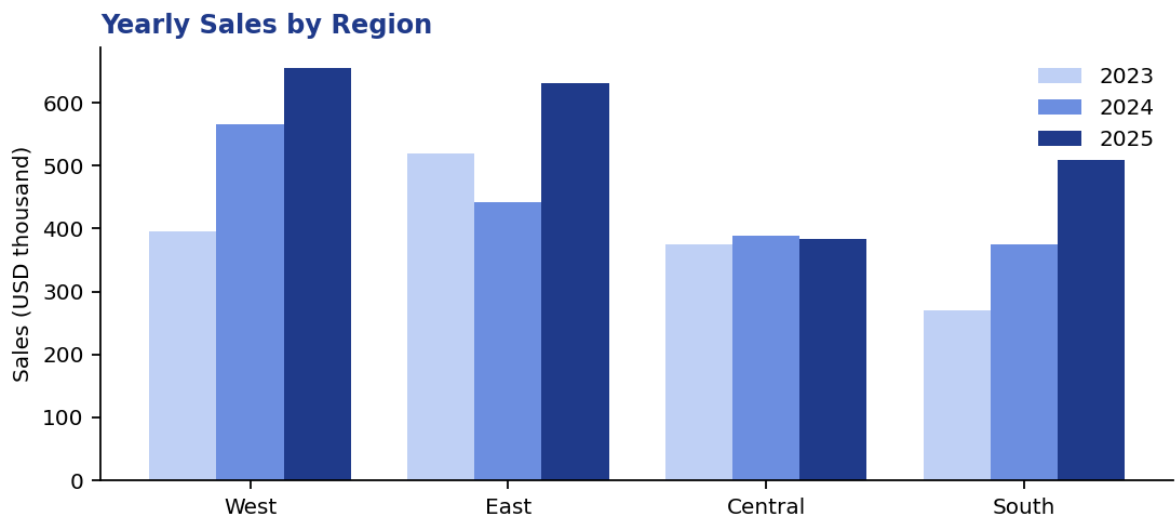
Key metric	Value
Total sales 2025	\$2,178,480
Company growth 2025 (YoY)	23.0%
Fastest region (CAGR)	South, 37.5%
Weakest region (CAGR)	Central, 1.2%
Profit margin 2025	10.2%

3. Growth Table

Region	2023	2024	2025	YoY 2024	YoY 2025	CAGR
West	\$395,364	\$565,164	\$655,039	42.9%	15.9%	28.7%
East	\$518,726	\$441,844	\$631,415	-14.8%	42.9%	10.3%
Central	\$374,220	\$388,178	\$382,880	3.7%	-1.4%	1.2%
South	\$269,257	\$375,577	\$509,146	39.5%	35.6%	37.5%
Total	\$1,557,567	\$1,770,763	\$2,178,480	13.7%	23.0%	18.3%

YoY = (current year / previous year) - 1. CAGR = (2025 sales / 2023 sales)^(1/2) - 1.

4. Charts



5. Profit by Region

Region	2023	2024	2025	YoY 2025	Margin 2023	Margin 2025
West	\$41,000	\$63,653	\$66,197	4.0%	10.4%	10.1%
East	\$62,817	\$44,576	\$68,087	52.7%	12.1%	10.8%
Central	\$34,415	\$42,045	\$31,018	-26.2%	9.2%	8.1%
South	\$32,736	\$34,446	\$57,228	66.1%	12.2%	11.2%
Total	\$170,967	\$184,720	\$222,530	20.5%	11.0%	10.2%

6. Quarter-over-Quarter and Same-Quarter Growth

Sales are strongly seasonal (Q4 is the peak), so QoQ numbers swing a lot. The same-quarter YoY view compares each quarter with the same quarter a year earlier and removes this seasonality.

Same-quarter YoY growth (2024 and 2025)

Region	24-Q1	24-Q2	24-Q3	24-Q4	25-Q1	25-Q2	25-Q3	25-Q4
West	-14.3%	44.1%	141.2%	25.8%	75.5%	17.4%	-31.2%	37.8%
East	-35.9%	-31.1%	3.8%	4.2%	8.6%	161.9%	68.6%	11.7%
Central	30.8%	-2.9%	42.3%	-23.8%	-27.4%	25.9%	-17.0%	15.8%
South	-9.6%	106.0%	46.0%	53.7%	44.0%	50.3%	73.0%	-0.1%
Total	-13.8%	18.5%	58.3%	9.7%	21.1%	52.0%	9.0%	17.4%

QoQ growth (Q1 2023 is the base period)

Region	23-Q2	23-Q3	23-Q4	24-Q1	24-Q2	24-Q3	24-Q4	25-Q1	25-Q2	25-Q3	25-Q4
West	-2.0%	-15.0%	80.0%	-42.8%	64.8%	42.2%	-6.1%	-20.2%	10.2%	-16.7%	88.1%
East	-47.7%	-3.4%	109.4%	-39.5%	-43.7%	45.5%	110.2%	-37.0%	35.8%	-6.3%	39.2%
Central	6.0%	-14.5%	120.2%	-34.5%	-21.4%	25.4%	17.9%	-37.6%	36.4%	-17.3%	64.5%
South	-52.1%	15.9%	73.0%	-5.8%	9.0%	-17.8%	82.1%	-11.7%	13.8%	-5.4%	5.2%
Total	-29.2%	-7.1%	97.5%	-33.7%	-2.7%	24.1%	36.9%	-26.8%	22.1%	-11.0%	47.4%

7. Five Key Insights

1. **South is the growth leader.** Sales rose from \$269,257 to \$509,146, a CAGR of 37.5%, with strong growth in both 2024 (39.5%) and 2025 (35.6%).
2. **Central is stagnating.** CAGR is only 1.2%, and 2025 sales (\$382,880) are slightly below 2024 (\$388,178).
3. **East's rebound is partly a small-base effect.** East fell 14.8% in 2024 and then grew 42.9% in 2025. Because 2024 is a low base, the 2025 growth looks larger than the underlying trend; its CAGR is 10.3%.
4. **The regional mix is shifting.** South's share of total sales rose from 17.3% to 23.4%, while Central's share fell from 24.0% to 17.6%.
5. **Seasonality is strong.** Q4 delivers 30.5% to 35.8% of annual sales depending on region (an even split would be 25%). Always compare the same quarter across years rather than Q4 against Q1.

8. Suggested Next Steps

- Review pricing, product mix and discounting in Central to find why growth has stalled.
- Check whether South can keep its pace as its base gets larger, and plan stock and delivery capacity for it.
- Prepare inventory and staffing for the Q4 peak in every region.
- Track growth on a same-quarter YoY basis in future dashboards to avoid seasonal distortion.

9. Method and Limitations

Source data: superstore.csv (5,000 orders). Calculations were done in Excel with SUMIFS formulas and in SQL with window functions (LAG); the two files that accompany this report contain the full workings. Growth rates over only three years are sensitive to the starting year, so CAGR should be read together with the yearly YoY figures. The data is synthetic, so conclusions apply to this dataset only.